Quill

Install and quick start · version 0.1.12

Quill is a writing assistant for the Mac, made for people who write English as a second language. It checks what you type in any app — Slack, Mail, your browser, Jira — and suggests fixes and rewrites right next to the text field.

Private by design. The spelling and grammar checks and the writing model both run on your own Mac. Nothing you write is sent anywhere: no accounts, no analytics, no cloud. Quill only goes online to download the writing model, once, and to ask GitHub whether there's a newer version of Quill. Neither sends anything you've written, and Quill verifies both downloads before using them.

1. Install

Before you start: become a local administrator. Open the **PaymentIQ Self Service** app and request **Administrator Mode**. You need it to put Quill in Applications and to allow it under Accessibility. Do the same before each update.

1. Download **Quill-0.1.12-universal.dmg** from the Releases page: github.com/nicklasklasson/quill/releases.
2. Open the dmg and drag **Quill** onto **Applications**. Eject the Quill disk afterwards.
3. Open Quill from Applications. macOS will most likely say *"Apple could not verify 'Quill' is free of malware that may harm your Mac or compromise your privacy"*, with the buttons **Done** and **Move to Bin**. Click **Done**, never Move to Bin. Then open **Terminal** and run this line:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Quill.app
```

Open Quill again and it starts normally. If Terminal says "Permission denied", run the same line with **sudo** in front and type your Mac password (nothing shows while you type). Why this is needed: Quill isn't registered with Apple (that takes a paid developer account), so macOS warns about every app downloaded from the internet that isn't. The line only removes the "downloaded from the internet" mark; it doesn't change Quill. Instead of Terminal you can also try **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Open Anyway**, but on company Macs that button often doesn't appear.

4. Quill now lives in the menu bar as a small feather, and in the Dock. A welcome panel appears in the top-right corner.
5. In the welcome panel, click a writing model to download it (see section 5). **Gemma 4 12B** is suggested on Macs with 16 GB of memory or more. You can keep working while it downloads.
6. Click into any text field, for example a Slack message. When macOS asks, open **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Accessibility** and switch on **Quill**. This is what lets Quill read and fix the field you're typing in.

If the badge doesn't appear after you've allowed Accessibility, quit Quill from the menu bar and open it again.

2. Everyday use: the badge

Click into any text field and a small round badge appears in its bottom-right corner. It follows you between fields and apps; when you leave a field it disappears, and it comes back when you return.

Click the badge, or press **⌥⌘G** (Option-Command-G), to open the panel. Press it again, or **Esc**, to close it.

Quill skips password fields, search boxes and address bars, and doesn't look into Terminal or password managers.

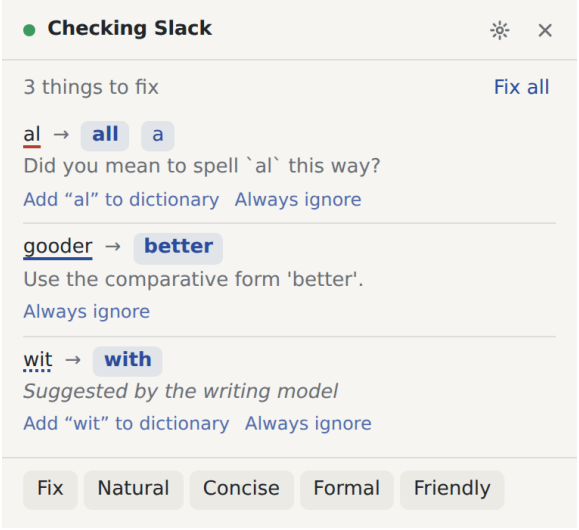
Looks good. Nothing to fix.

Things to fix. The number of suggestions.

Checking. The ring spins while Quill looks closer.

3. Fixing what you wrote

The panel lists everything to fix, with the suggested change in blue. **Click the blue word** to apply it in the field, or click **Fix all**.



Spelling and grammar suggestions appear instantly as you type. When you pause, the writing model takes a closer look and adds what a spell-checker can't catch, such as "wit" for "with" or "you" for "your". Its suggestions have a dotted underline.

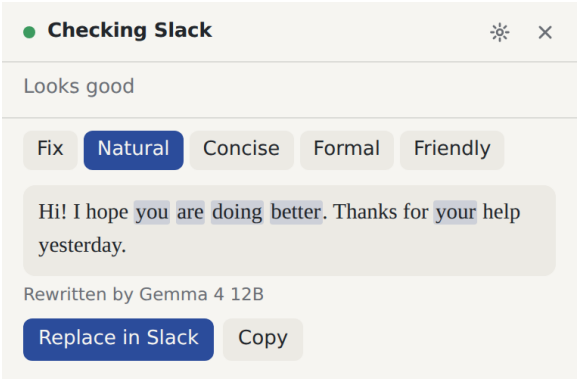
Add "word" to dictionary appears under flagged words. Use it for names and jargon, and Quill and the writing model leave them alone from then on. Common PaymentIQ words, such as PIQ, MID and 3DS, are already in the shared team dictionary that comes with Quill.

Always ignore hides that exact suggestion for good. Both lists are in Settings, where you can undo them.

4. Rewriting

The buttons at the bottom of the panel rewrite the whole text with the writing model:

Button	What it does
Fix	Corrects mistakes only and keeps your wording.
Natural	Reads the way a native speaker would write it.
Concise	Shorter, same meaning.
Formal	Polite and professional, for customers and stakeholders.
Friendly	Warm and relaxed, for colleagues.



Changed words are highlighted. **Replace in Slack** (or whichever app you're in) puts the result into the field; **Copy** puts it on the clipboard instead. The first rewrite after a break takes a little longer while the model loads.

Pausing and switching off

Right-click the badge for these options:

- **Pause in Slack for 1 hour** or **until tomorrow morning** (06:00): Quill leaves that app alone for a while, then picks up again by itself.
- **Pause everywhere for 1 hour**.
- **Don't check in Slack**: switches Quill off in that app until you turn it back on in Settings.
- **Turn off automatic checking**: no badges anywhere; the hotkey still works when you want a check.

The menu bar icon dims while anything is paused, and its menu lists each pause with a **Resume** item. **Pause everywhere** is in that menu too, and in the menu you get by right-clicking Quill in the Dock.

If you press ⌥⌘G in a field that Quill isn't checking by itself, the panel tells you why (paused, excluded, or automatic checking off) and offers a button to turn it back on.

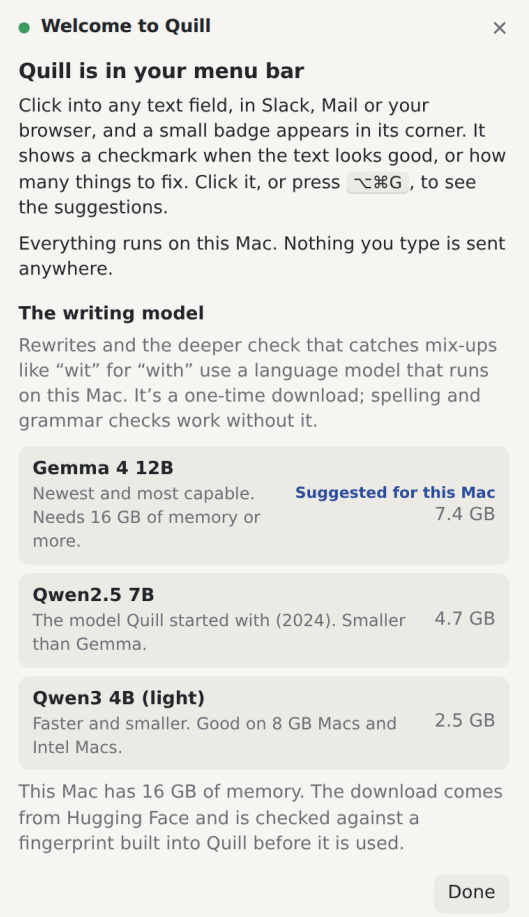
5. Choosing the writing model

The writing model is what catches mix-ups and writes the rewrites. It runs on your Mac and is downloaded once from inside Quill. Spelling and grammar checks work without it.

Model	Size	Best for
Gemma 4 12B	7.4 GB	Macs with 16 GB of memory or more. The newest and most capable.
Qwen2.5 7B	4.7 GB	The model Quill started with.
Qwen3 4B (light)	2.5 GB	8 GB Macs and Intel Macs.

Quill suggests one for your Mac. To check how much memory your Mac has: **Apple menu › About This Mac**.

A download can be paused and continues where it stopped. You can download more than one model and switch between them in Settings; each rewrite says which model wrote it. While loaded, a model uses roughly its download size in memory, and Quill unloads it after 10 idle minutes.



Settings

Open Settings from the menu bar icon, the gear in the panel, by clicking Quill in the Dock, or with ⌘, while Quill is active. There you can change the hotkey, choose British or American English, skip text that isn’t English (handy when you also write Swedish), turn the automatic badge or the background model check on or off, manage your dictionary, ignored suggestions, paused and excluded apps, and switch or remove writing models.

Team words are listed at the top of the dictionary. They’re shared with everyone and updated with each new version. Click × on one to switch it off just for you. To get a word added for everyone, click **Suggest your words for the team dictionary**: it opens an email with your own words, ready to send.

6. Updating to a new version

Quill updates itself. Once a day it asks GitHub whether there’s a newer version; when there is, it lets you know with a notification and an **Update to Quill …** item in the menu bar menu.

1. Request **Administrator Mode** in the PaymentIQ Self Service app.
2. Choose **Update to Quill …** (or **Check for Updates…**) in the menu bar menu, then click **Install and restart**.

Quill downloads the new version, checks that it’s signed with the Quill certificate, replaces itself in Applications and restarts. Your settings, dictionary and downloaded model are kept, and there’s no “could not verify” warning. You can switch the daily check off in Settings.

Updating by hand works too: quit Quill, download the new dmg from the Releases page, drag Quill to Applications and choose **Replace**. If macOS then says it could not verify Quill, click **Done** and run the Terminal

line from step 3 of the installation.

Quill keeps its Accessibility permission across updates. If it ever says it needs the permission even though Quill is switched on in System Settings, click **Reset permission** in its panel, then switch Quill on again.

7. If something doesn’t work

What you see	What to do
No badge appears anywhere	Open the menu bar menu: if it starts with “Quill needs the Accessibility permission”, choose **Allow Quill…** and follow the panel. Otherwise press ⌥⌘G in a text field: the panel says if automatic checking is off or paused, with a button to fix it.
No badge in one app	The app may be paused or excluded (see Settings). Some apps, such as Google Docs and terminals, don’t let Quill read their text; press ⌥⌘G there to use the scratchpad instead.
“Apple could not verify ‘Quill’ is free of malware”	Click **Done** and run xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Quill.app in Terminal (see step 3 of the installation). Make sure Quill is in Applications, not opened from the dmg.
An update says it needs Administrator Mode	Request Administrator Mode in the PaymentIQ Self Service app, then click **Try again** in Quill’s update panel.
Rewrite buttons are missing	The writing model isn’t downloaded yet. Download it from the panel or from Settings.
“Replaced by pasting”	Some apps don’t let Quill change text directly, so it selects all and pastes. Your clipboard is restored afterwards.
The first suggestion is slow	The model loads after a break, which takes a few seconds. After that it’s quick.

Questions or problems? Contact Nicklas Klasson, nicklas.klasson@paymentiq.com. If something isn’t working, open Settings, click **Copy diagnostics** and paste it into your message. It never contains anything you’ve written.